	immediately after the death of the Prophet between those who recognised the authority of the Medinian Caliphs and those who followed the Prophet's son-in-law Ali (Shi'at Ali means 'the Party of Ali' in Arabic). Though most Shi'ites live in Iran, there have always been a few in Afghanistan and India.
shir maheh	An Afghan freshwater river fish not dissimilar in taste to trout.
sipahee	The original Persian word for soldier, which was turned by British tongues into 'sepoy' and came to mean specifically an Indian soldier in the service of the East India Company.
surwan	A camel driver.
syce	A groom.
talib	A religious student.
takht	A seat or throne.
thannah	A police post or police station presided over by a thanadar.
toman	A Persian unit of currency. At the time of the First Afghan War five tomans were worth around £1.
tykhana	A cool underground room or network of cool rooms.
'ulema	In Arabic, this means 'the ones possessing knowledge', hence 'the community of learned men'. In effect it means the Islamic clergy, the body of men with sufficient knowledge of the Quran, the Sunna and the Sharia to make decisions on matters of religion. The word ulema is an Arabic plural; the singular is alim, a learned man.
vakil	Representative, headman or ambassador. In modern usage the word usually means lawyer.
waqf	An inalienable religious endowment in Islamic law, usually a religious building or a plot of land reserved for Muslim religious or charitable purposes.
wazir	A councillor of the state, a minister.
Yaghistan	Pashtun notion of their territories as a 'land of freedom and rebellion'.